

C01 - Assessment

Tool - 3

Name: Sanjay Krishnan . R

Reg No: 192521055

Course: Ethical Hacking

Code: ITA 1412

Date: 28/7/26

1. =>

Some Key Ethical boundaries:

→ Avoid exploiting severe emotional distress:

* Message about layoffs, deaths, medical emergencies, or other highly personal topics can trigger anxiety, panic, or lasting emotional harm that goes beyond measuring security awareness.

→ Use proportional realism:

* Simulation should resemble realistic cyber threats employees might actually encounter, but they should not rely on deception that unnecessarily manipulates fear or vulnerability.

→ Protect privacy:

* Collect only the information necessary to evaluate the exercise, and limit access to individual results. Aggregate reporting is often preferable.

Psychological Impact:

A fake layoff email can have unintended consequences, such as.

- Increased stress and anxiety, especially during periods of organizational uncertainty.
- Reduce trust in company communications and leadership.
- Lower morale and employee engagement if staff feel manipulated.

Security Training Outcomes:

- * Fake password expiration notices
- * Simulated document-sharing invitations
- * IT support or software update request.
- * Package delivery notifications.
- * Benefits enrollment reminders (reviewed to avoid undue distress).

These scenarios still teach employees to verify links, inspect sender details, and report suspicious emails without relying on highly distressing themes.